CRIMINALIZING REPORTING

Morocco v. Hajar Raissouni et al.

9 October 2026

CASE FOLLOW-UP REPORT

Procedural developments and verified outcomes

Independent research based on user-supplied TrialWatch materials

ABOUT THIS UPDATE

This independent research update follows the user-supplied TrialWatch material. It is not issued by the Clooney Foundation for Justice, TrialWatch, or the original authors. The earlier report supplies the historical baseline; later developments are supported by the sources cited here.

Jurisdiction	Morocco
Original report	August 2020
Dated update covered	2 November 2022
Research cutoff	9 October 2026
Historical assessment	TrialWatch grade D (original report only)

SCOPE AND METHOD

Research considered public court records, enacted legislation, lawyers and subjects, press-freedom organizations, United Nations materials and attributable reporting available through 9 October 2026. Publication dates and event dates are distinguished. Where judgments or current custody records could not be obtained, the conclusion is expressly qualified. No direct interviews or new trial monitoring were conducted for this update.

An acquittal, quashing order, pardon, sentence completion, bail decision and custody transfer have different legal effects. A reported intention to litigate is separated from an actual filing. Unresolved questions are listed below. Historical TrialWatch grades retain their original attribution; this update does not assign a new grade.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

LATEST VERIFIED POSITION

Pardoned in 2019; no subsequent acquittal or vacatur verified

The latest located subject-specific follow-up is a published interview, not a new judicial disposition. The pardon and release occurred on 16 October 2019 and were already recorded in the original report. The record located through 9 October 2026 does not establish that the convictions were subsequently quashed.

Hajar Raissouni and her co-defendants received a royal pardon on 16 October 2019. This was not a post-report development: the August 2020 TrialWatch report already distinguished the pardon from an acquittal. Amnesty International likewise reported that the convictions had not been quashed. The appropriate follow-up status is therefore pardon and release, without a verified later judicial clearing of the case. [1] [2]

The latest located direct follow-up is Raissouni's interview published on 2 November 2022, describing post-release harassment and her subsequent life in Paris. Her earlier first-person account also described leaving Morocco. These accounts establish reported continuing consequences, not a new prosecution, a judicial finding of surveillance, or a 2026 determination of her circumstances. [4] [5]

1. User-supplied original report, August 2020.
2. Amnesty International, 21 November 2019. Journalist released after royal pardon: Hajar...
4. MO* (Raissouni first-person opi..., 24 August 2021. Marokko is een grote gevangenis voor mij
5. Marie Colvin Journalists' Network, 2 November 2022. Interview with Hajar Raissouni

BACKGROUND AND PROCEDURAL HISTORY

The original report concerned five defendants arrested in connection with Raissouni's medical treatment on 31 August 2019: Raissouni, her fiance Rifaat Al Amine, doctor Jamal Belkeziz, anesthesiologist Mohamed Baba, and secretary Khadija Azelmadh. Raissouni was prosecuted for abortion and sexual relations outside marriage under Articles 454 and 490 of the Penal Code. On 30 September 2019, she and her fiance received one-year prison sentences; the doctor received two years; the other two defendants received suspended eight-month sentences. All five were pardoned on 16 October. [1]

TrialWatch expert Baroness Helena Kennedy assigned the proceedings a D grade. The report identified an invasive medical examination without consent, impediments to counsel, judicial impartiality concerns, contested police statements treated as confessions, and restrictions on defense evidence. Its assessment that the prosecution implicated discriminatory enforcement and Raissouni's journalism is the original expert's assessment, not a newly established judicial finding. The report explicitly stated that pardon did not erase conviction. [1]

KEY PROCEDURAL DATES

31 August 2019	Raissouni and the other defendants were arrested in connection with her medical treatment. [1]
12 September 2019	MENA Rights Group submitted the situation to seven UN Special Procedures mandates, according to its case profile. [3]
30 September 2019	The court convicted the five defendants. A UN Special Procedures communication was also issued on this date; these are separate actions. [1] [3]
16 October 2019	Royal pardon of all five defendants; release of the imprisoned defendants. No acquittal was recorded. [1] [2]
August 2020	Original TrialWatch report published, already incorporating the pardon. [1]
8 June 2021	MENA Rights Group updated its profile, identifying Raissouni as free and recording the earlier UN intervention. [3]
24 August 2021	Raissouni's first-person essay described post-release harassment and departure from Morocco. [4]
2 November 2022	A published interview with Raissouni described continuing pressure after release and her life in Paris. [5]

1. User-supplied original report, August 2020.
2. Amnesty International, 21 November 2019. Journalist released after royal pardon: Hajar...
3. MENA Rights Group, 2021-06-08 (profile updat.... La journaliste marocaine Hajar Raissouni pour...
4. MO* (Raissouni first-person opi..., 24 August 2021. Marokko is een grote gevangenis voor mij
5. Marie Colvin Journalists' Network, 2 November 2022. Interview with Hajar Raissouni

SUBSEQUENT DEVELOPMENTS

The 2021 MENA Rights Group update documents an actual September 2019 submission and a subsequent Special Procedures communication, rather than merely an intention to seek UN assistance. Both actions preceded the original report. The profile's later update confirms the release classification but does not supply a subsequent court judgment or a UN merits decision. [3]

In her August 2021 essay, Raissouni described harassment after release, an initial obstacle to leaving Morocco that was later resolved, and continued attacks while abroad. She also discussed her and her husband's numbers appearing in leaked Pegasus-related records. That account should not be converted into a claim of independently verified infection of either device. [4]

The November 2022 interview provides a later personal account of surveillance-like pressure following the pardon and relocation abroad. The source's introductory wording associates release with 17 October, whereas the original report and Amnesty identify 16 October as the operative pardon/release date. This follow-up retains the better-corroborated date and treats the interview as evidence of her reported experience, not adjudicated responsibility. [1] [2] [5]

LEGAL AND PROCEDURAL ASSESSMENT

The following assessment draws inferences from the cited record. It does not represent a new court finding or TrialWatch grade.

the decisive distinction is between ending imprisonment and correcting the legal record. Because the original report and Amnesty expressly distinguished pardon from quashing, an account describing the case simply as overturned would be misleading. A later rehabilitation, appeal judgment, or record-clearing measure would require its own evidence; none was located in the bounded searches. [1] [2]

the later personal accounts make the report's concern about consequences beyond imprisonment relevant to the follow-up. They do not prove that every original procedural defect remains legally unremedied, nor establish the present situation of the doctor and clinic staff. The available evidence supports a narrower conclusion: release occurred, while reported pressure continued and judicial vindication has not been verified. [1] [4] [5]

1. User-supplied original report, August 2020.
2. Amnesty International, 21 November 2019. Journalist released after royal pardon: Hajar...
3. MENA Rights Group, 2021-06-08 (profile updat.... La journaliste marocaine Hajar Raissouni pour...
4. MO* (Raissouni first-person opi..., 24 August 2021. Marokko is een grote gevangenis voor mij
5. Marie Colvin Journalists' Network, 2 November 2022. Interview with Hajar Raissouni

CONCLUSION AND OUTSTANDING RECORDS

The report should retain the original D grade as historical attribution and identify the 2019 pardon as the established disposition. Post-report developments concern Raissouni's reported harassment and relocation, rather than a verified reversal. The absence of a located newer judgment is a research limitation, not proof that no further legal action occurred. [1] [4] [5]

RECORDS NOT VERIFIED

1. Was any conviction later vacated, expunged, or otherwise removed from the criminal record? Obtain the operative pardon instrument and any subsequent court or rehabilitation order.

2. Did any defendant pursue an appeal or compensation claim after the pardon, and what was its disposition?

3. What happened to the professional sanctions, fines, and records of the doctor and clinic staff? The later subject interviews do not answer this.

4. Was there any later response or substantive determination following UN communication AL MAR 4/2019? The located profile establishes intervention, not final resolution.

5. No subject-specific legal event later than the located follow-up accounts was verified through the cutoff. Current residence and safety require fresher direct confirmation.

Failure to locate an update leaves a gap in the available evidence; it does not establish that no later proceeding or change occurred. Any present-status claim should be read with the dated scope stated in the executive summary.

1. User-supplied original report, August 2020.

4. MO* (Raissouni first-person opi..., 24 August 2021. Marokko is een grote gevangenis voor mij

5. Marie Colvin Journalists' Network, 2 November 2022. Interview with Hajar Raissouni

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

Numbered references correspond to superscript citations and page notes. Web sources were consulted for this research through 9 October 2026. Original reports are local user-supplied files. Each link opens the cited source.

1. **Original user-supplied report on Morocco v. Hajar Raissouni et al.**
TrialWatch / original report authors. August 2020.
Local PDF: morocco-v-hajar-raissouni-et-al.pdf
Coverage: Historical case baseline and original assessment

2. **Journalist released after royal pardon: Hajar Raissouni**
Amnesty International. 21 November 2019.
Read source at www.amnesty.org
Coverage: Pardon and release on 16 October 2019; Convictions were not quashed; The publication date is the date on the document, not its later upload directory

3. **La journaliste marocaine Hajar Raissouni poursuivie en violation de son droit a la vie privee**
MENA Rights Group. 2021-06-08 (profile update; first published 2019-09-12).
Read source at menarights.org
Coverage: Release classification; Submission to seven UN mandates on 12 September 2019; Special Procedures communication dated 30 September 2019

4. **Marokko is een grote gevangenis voor mij**
MO* (Raissouni first-person opinion, translated from Daraj). 24 August 2021.
Read source at www.mo.be
Coverage: Reported harassment after release and departure from Morocco; Her account of Pegasus-related targeting records, not device-forensic confirmation

5. **Interview with Hajar Raissouni**
Marie Colvin Journalists' Network. 2 November 2022.
Read source at mariecolvinnetwork.org
Coverage: Reported post-pardon pressure; Interview identifies her life in Paris; Publication is a personal follow-up, not a court ruling